

A FREE 5-DAY PROGRAM

THE *First* FIVE DAYS

A 5-day off-ice training program for young hockey players.

Bodyweight only. **No gym required.** 30 minutes a session. Built on the same Long-Term Athletic Development principles used by elite-level coaching programs.

01 FOUNDATION

02 SPEED

03 STRENGTH

04 PLYO

05 TEST DAY

COACH DAVID CIBOCH

M.ED. SPORT SCIENCE • 10+ YEARS COACHING

@ELITE_HOCKEY_DRILLS
ELITEHOCKEYDRILLS.COM

TRAIN YOUNG. TRAIN *smart.*

Between the ages of 9 and 13, your body is in what sport scientists call the "Train to Train" window — a stage of the Long-Term Athletic Development (LTAD) model where you learn how to move faster, jump higher, and control your body with more skill than at any other point in your life.

This is not the time to chase heavy weights or grind through brutal workouts. It's the time to build the engine. The coordination, the speed, the body awareness — all the things the pros wish they had spent more time on at your age.

These five days are designed around that idea. Bodyweight only. Movement quality first. Real progress you can measure by Day 5.

01

MOVEMENT FIRST

Every rep is a chance to teach your body a pattern it will use for the next ten years. We move well before we move fast.

02

SPEED IS A SKILL

Speed and quickness are most trainable right now. We train them through short, sharp efforts — and games.

03

MEASURE PROGRESS

Day 5 is a Test Day. You record your scores. Then you come back in a few weeks and beat them.

*"If a rep looks ugly, slow down.
Quality is the whole game."*

FIVE DAYS. ONE WEEK. ONE *better* PLAYER.

Pick five days that work for you — they don't have to be Monday through Friday. Leave at least one rest day in the middle if you can. Each session is 30 to 40 minutes including warm-up and cool-down. You only need a small open space and a floor. No equipment. If something hurts (not "burns" — actually hurts), stop. Tell a parent or coach. Pain is information.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY 01 ATHLETIC FOUNDATION ~ 35 MIN	DAY 02 SPEED & QUICKNESS ~ 30 MIN	DAY 03 STRENGTH SKILLS ~ 35 MIN	DAY 04 PLYO PLAY ~ 30 MIN	DAY 05 ATHLETE TEST DAY ~ 40 MIN
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HOW TO READ A WORKOUT

EVERY EXERCISE CARD HAS FIVE PARTS.

The number is just the order. Sets and reps tell you how many. Tempo tells you the speed — a 3-1-1-0 tempo means 3 seconds lowering, 1 second pause, 1 second up, 0 rest at the top.

Rest is how long you wait before the next set. The **coaching cue** is the one thing your coach would say standing next to you. "**What it builds**" tells you the hockey reason for the work.

01 EXERCISE NAME	<i>the movement</i>
3 × 8	<i>sets × reps</i>
TEMPO: 3-1-1-0	<i>speed of the rep</i>
REST: 60s	<i>before the next set</i>
HOW TO DO IT	<i>exact instructions</i>
COACHING CUE	<i>the one thing</i>
WHAT IT BUILDS	<i>the hockey reason</i>

THE *warm-up*

Three movements. Five minutes. Every single day. The warm-up is not optional — it's how you wake your body up and avoid silly injuries. Move with control. Breathe through your nose if you can.

01 SPIDER LUNGE WITH REACH

2 ROUNDS × 4 EACH SIDE

"Open up the hips. Open up the chest."

Start in a push-up position. Step your right foot up beside your right hand. Reach your right arm up to the ceiling and follow it with your eyes. Place the hand back down, step back, switch sides. Move slowly.

BUILDS Hip mobility and a long, ready spine before the workout.

02 INCHWORM TO PUSH-UP

2 ROUNDS × 4 REPS

"Whole body, every rep."

Stand tall. Bend forward and walk your hands out into a push-up position. Do one push-up (knees down is fine). Walk your hands back toward your feet. Stand up. Repeat.

BUILDS Full-body activation — shoulders, core, and hamstrings firing together.

03 SKIP WITH HIGH KNEES

2 ROUNDS × 20m / 30s

"Tall and bouncy. Like you've got springs."

Skip forward. Drive the front knee high. Pump the opposite arm hard. Land soft on the ball of your foot. Stay tall. This is not jogging — it's bouncy and athletic.

BUILDS Wakes up your nervous system and gets the legs ready to be fast.

01

ATHLETIC
FOUND-
ation.

Today is about teaching your body the five movements you will use for the rest of your athletic life. We move slowly. We move well. Every rep is a chance to get a little better at how your body works.

BEGIN WITH

The Warm-Up (Page 04). Always.

~ 35 MIN • BODYWEIGHT ONLY

01 BODYWEIGHT SQUAT

3 × 8 Tempo 3-1-1-0 Rest 60s

Feet a little wider than shoulders, toes slightly turned out. Push your hips back like you're sitting into a chair, knees tracking over your toes. Go as deep as you can while keeping your chest tall and heels on the floor. Stand back up.

"Chest proud. Knees out. Slow down on the way down."

BUILDS The foundation of every skating stride. Strong squat, more powerful stride.

02 PUSH-UP (KNEES OK)

3 × 6-8 Tempo 2-1-1-0 Rest 60s

Hands under your shoulders, body in a straight line head to heels (or to knees if needed). Lower your chest to within a fist of the floor. Push back up without letting your hips sag or pike up.

"Straight line, head to heels. Squeeze the floor away."

BUILDS Upper-body push strength — for battles along the boards and stick control under pressure.

03 GLUTE BRIDGE

3 × 10 2s pause at top Rest 45s

Lie on your back, knees bent, feet a hand's-width from your butt. Push through your heels and lift your hips until your body forms a straight line knees-to-shoulders. Squeeze your glutes hard at the top. Lower slowly.

"Squeeze the glutes — not the lower back."

BUILDS Glute strength. Glutes are the engine of skating. Most young players don't know how to use them yet. Today you start.

04 BEAR CRAWL

3 rounds 5m fwd + 5m back Rest 60s

Hands and feet on the floor, knees hovering one inch up. Move forward stepping opposite hand and foot at the same time. Back flat — imagine a glass of water on it you can't spill.

"Hips low. Don't spill the water."

BUILDS Full-body coordination — your brain learning to move the right limbs at the right time.

05 DEAD BUG

2 × 8 each side Slow Rest 45s

Lie on your back. Arms straight up to the ceiling. Knees bent 90°, lifted off the floor. Slowly lower right arm overhead AND left leg toward the floor at the same time. Don't let your lower back lift off the floor. Switch sides.

"Press your back into the floor the whole time."

BUILDS Deep core control — the kind that keeps you stable when someone tries to knock you off the puck.

COOL-DOWN — 2 MIN

Lie on your back, knees bent. Breathe in for 4 seconds, hold for 4, breathe out for 6 seconds. Two minutes. This teaches your body how to switch off after training.

02

SPEED &
QUICK-
ness.

Speed is a skill, not a gift. Today is short, sharp efforts — the kind that build your first three steps. Between sets, you rest fully. Speed isn't about being tired. It's about being fast every rep.

BEGIN WITH

The Warm-Up (Page 04). Don't skip.

~ 30 MIN • OPEN SPACE + 2 MARKERS

01 WALL DRIVE

4 × 5s each leg Rest 30s

Arm's length from a wall. Hands flat on the wall, lean at 45° — body in a straight line head to heels. Drive one knee up to hip height, hold 5 seconds. Back foot pushing into the floor like leaving a footprint.

"Push the floor away. Knee up like punching the sky."

BUILDS Sprint posture and the exact angle you need to accelerate from a stop. First-step mechanics.

02 LATERAL SHUFFLE BURSTS

5 rounds 5m R + 5m L Rest 45s

Two markers about 5 meters apart (water bottles work). Athletic stance — knees bent, chest up. Shuffle to the right marker, touch the floor, shuffle back to the left, touch the floor. Feet do not cross.

"Stay low. Eyes up. Feet never cross."

BUILDS Lateral quickness — the foundation of every change of direction on the ice.

03 MIRROR GAME (OR SHADOW)

4 rounds × 20s Rest 60s

With a partner: stand 2 meters apart. Partner A moves — shuffle, jump, drop, anything. Partner B mirrors as fast as possible. Switch after each round. Solo version: imagine an opponent in front of you and react to invisible cuts. Athletic stance the whole 20 seconds.

"React. Don't think — react."

BUILDS Reaction speed. The brain reading movement and responding instantly. The secret weapon of every great defenseman.

04 REACTIVE 5-METER SPRINT

6 reps Full rest between reps

Start in different positions each time: standing, kneeling, seated, lying on your stomach. On "GO" (your own or a partner's call), explode up and sprint 5 meters. Walk back. Reset in a new position.

"Every start is a new start. Get up and go."

BUILDS First-step explosiveness — the ability to win the race to a loose puck.

COOL-DOWN — 2 MIN

Slow walk 90 seconds. Sit cross-legged and roll your shoulders backward 10 times, forward 10 times. Done.

03

STRENGTH
skills.

Strength at your age isn't about how much you can lift. It's about how well you can control your own bodyweight in tricky positions. Single legs. Tight cores. Slow, hard work. This is the day that builds the body you'll thank yourself for in three years.

BEGIN WITH

The Warm-Up (Page 04).

~ 35 MIN • BODYWEIGHT ONLY

01 SPLIT SQUAT

3 × 6 each leg Tempo 3-1-1-0 Rest 60s

Long stride position — one foot forward, one foot back, about a meter apart. Drop your back knee straight down toward the floor (don't crash — hover an inch above). Front knee tracks over the front foot. Push through your front heel to stand up.

"Tall chest. Back knee down — don't crash."

BUILDS Single-leg strength. Skating is a single-leg sport. Every stride is one leg at a time. Train it that way.

02 SINGLE-LEG GLUTE BRIDGE

3 × 8 each leg 2s pause Rest 60s

On your back, knees bent, one foot flat on the floor and the other leg extended straight up. Push through the heel of the planted foot, lift your hips. Both hip bones should point at the ceiling — don't let one side drop.

"Hips square. Don't let one side dip."

BUILDS Glute strength on each side independently. Most athletes have a weaker side. Today you find yours and fix it.

03 HOLLOW HOLD

3 × 20s Rest 45s

On your back. Press your lower back firmly into the floor. Lift your shoulder blades just off the ground. Lift your legs 6 inches up. Arms overhead, biceps next to your ears. You should look like a shallow banana. Breathe.

"Glue your back to the floor. Don't let it lift."

BUILDS Anterior core strength — what holds your body together when you take contact or twist hard to find a shot.

04 PIKE PUSH-UP (OR HOLD)

3 × 5 or 20s hold Rest 60s

Downward-dog position — hands on the floor, butt high, body in an upside-down V. Bend your elbows and lower the top of your head toward the floor between your hands. Push back up. Too hard? Hold the upside-down V with straight arms for 20 seconds.

"Hips high. Push the floor away."

BUILDS Shoulder strength and the foundation for harder pushing movements down the road.

05 INCHWORM

2 × 6 Rest 45s

Stand tall. Bend forward at the hips and place your hands on the floor. Walk your hands forward one at a time until you're in a long plank position. Hold one second. Walk your hands back to your feet. Stand up.

"Long arms. Tight middle."

BUILDS Hamstring length, shoulder stability, and full-body coordination in one clean movement.

COOL-DOWN — 2 MIN

Lie on your back, hug your knees to your chest, slowly rock side to side for 60 seconds. Then breathe in for 4, out for 6, ten times.

04

PLYO-
play.

Today we jump. But the lesson of today isn't how high you go — it's how you *land*. Soft, quiet, controlled landings teach your tendons and joints to handle force the right way. Every great skater is a great lander first.

BEGIN WITH

The Warm-Up (Page 04).

~ 30 MIN • SOFT SURFACE IDEAL

LANDING FIRST

The rule of every jump today: land softer than you jumped. Quiet feet. Bent knees. Hold each landing for one full second before the next rep. If your landing is loud, you're not ready for the next one.

01 POGO HOPS

3 × 10 Quiet, quick Rest 60s

Tall. Bounce up and down on the balls of your feet, legs almost straight. The bounce comes from your ankles and calves, not from bending your knees. Quick, light, quiet contacts with the floor.

"Feet like springs. Floor is hot lava — barely touch it."

BUILDS Ankle stiffness and quick reactivity — the foundation of explosive movement.

02 BROAD JUMP — STICK IT

5 reps Full rest (~45s)

Feet shoulder-width. Swing your arms back, bend your knees, jump forward as far as you can. The important part: when you land, freeze. Hold the landing for three full seconds. Knees bent, hips back, perfectly balanced.

"Jump far. Land like a statue."

BUILDS Lower-body power AND landing strength. The combo every hockey player needs.

03 LATERAL SKATER HOP

3 × 4 each side Rest 60s

Stand on your right leg. Push off sideways to the left, landing on your left leg only. Hold that landing for 2 seconds — balanced, knee bent, no wobble. Push back to the right leg. Hold. That's two reps.

"Land. Freeze. Then go again."

BUILDS The exact pattern of a skating stride — push off one leg, catch and stabilize on the other.

04 STEP-DOWN

3 × 5 each leg Rest 60s

Stand on a step, low bench, or thick book. Slowly lower one foot toward the floor over 3 seconds. Just tap the heel — don't put weight on it. Stand back up using the leg that stayed on the step.

"Slow on the way down. Knee tracks over the toes."

BUILDS Eccentric strength — your muscles learning to absorb force. This is how you stay injury-free.

05 SINGLE-LEG BALANCE

2 × 20s each leg Eyes closed Rest 30s

Stand on one foot. Close your eyes. Try to stay perfectly still for 20 seconds. You will wobble. That's the whole point — your body is learning to balance without using your eyes.

"Small wobbles are good. Big wobbles mean reset."

BUILDS Ankle and hip stability, plus the proprioception your body needs when you take a hit on the ice.

COOL-DOWN — 2 MIN

Slow walk 90 seconds. Breathe in for 4, out for 6. Roll your ankles in circles, 10 each direction.

05

ATHLETE
test day.

Today is your combine. Six tests. You record your scores. In four weeks, you come back and beat them. That's the game. Do a thorough warm-up (do The Warm-Up twice today). Rest fully between tests. You're not trying to be tired — you're trying to be your best.

01 BROAD JUMP — MAX DISTANCE

3 attempts. Best one counts. Stand still. Jump forward as far as you can. Measure from the starting line to where your heels land.

02 30-SECOND SHUTTLE TEST

30 seconds of continuous shuttle running between two markers 20m apart. Count the total number of touches.

03 PUSH-UPS IN 60 SECONDS

Max quality push-ups in 60 seconds (knees down is fine — be honest about which version). Touch a fist's height from the floor every rep.

04 PLANK HOLD — MAX TIME

Forearm plank. Body in a straight line. Time stops the moment your hips drop or form breaks.

05 BALANCE — EYES CLOSED

Stand on one foot, eyes closed, hands on hips. Time stops the moment the other foot touches down. Test both legs.

06 DEEP SQUAT HOLD

Sit into a deep squat as low as you can go with heels flat. Hold. Time stops when your heels lift or you stand up.

THE SCORECARD

BEAT IT IN 4 WEEKS

TEST

TODAY

NEXT TEST (4 WKS)

BROAD JUMP

___ cm / ___ in

SHUTTLE TOUCHES (30S)

___ touches

PUSH-UPS (60S)

___ reps

PLANK HOLD

___ : ___

BALANCE L / R

L ___s / R ___s

___ / ___

DEEP SQUAT HOLD

___ : ___

DATE ___/___/___

MY GOAL NEXT TEST _____

THE GAMES *library.*

Five games to play with teammates or friends on any rest day or weekend. Play hard. Compete. The best athletes in the world were the kids who played the most. This is training too — just disguised as fun.

01 SHARKS & MINNOWS

NEED: 4–10 PLAYERS, MARKED AREA

One player is the "shark" in the middle. Everyone else lines up on one side. On "GO," the minnows sprint to the other side without being tagged. Anyone tagged becomes a shark. Last minnow standing wins.

Acceleration, deceleration, change of direction.

02 THE MIRROR

NEED: 1 PARTNER

Stand 2 meters apart, facing each other. The "leader" is Partner A. Partner B copies every movement — shuffles, jumps, drops, spins — for 30 seconds. Then switch. Three rounds each.

Reaction time, lateral quickness, awareness.

03 LINE TAG

NEED: 2+ PLAYERS, LINES ON A COURT

Players can only run on the lines of a basketball or tennis court — no shortcuts across open ground. One player is "it" and tries to tag the others. When tagged, you become "it."

Footwork, agility, and a brain that thinks ahead.

04 ONE-LEG KING

NEED: 2+ PLAYERS, A SMALL CIRCLE

Two players inside the circle, each on one leg, arms folded. Push your opponent out of the circle — or make them put their other foot down — using only your shoulder. Best of five rounds.

Single-leg balance, contact comfort, hip strength.

05 STOPWATCH SPRINT

NEED: A STOPWATCH (PHONE), OPEN SPACE

Mark two points 10–20 meters apart. Sprint between them five times back and forth — full speed. Record your time. Try again next week. Try to beat it. Compete with yourself. That's the whole game.

Top-end speed, self-competition, the habit of measuring progress.

RECOVERY IS WHEN YOU GET *better*.

Training breaks your body down. Recovery is when your body builds back stronger. If you ignore this page, the five days of training do half of what they could.

SLEEP

9-11

HOURS PER NIGHT

Your body grows during deep sleep. Growth hormone — the chemical that builds muscle and bone — is released mostly while you're asleep. Athletes between 9 and 13 need 9 to 11 hours. Phones off an hour before bed. Same time every night if you can. This is your secret weapon.

FUEL

3

PARTS ON EVERY PLATE

Every meal: a protein (chicken, fish, eggs, lentils), a carb (rice, potato, bread, fruit), and a vegetable. That's the formula. Drink water with it. Eat a snack 30 minutes after any training session — a piece of fruit and some yogurt or nuts is perfect. We don't count calories. We eat real food often.

HYDRATION

6-8

GLASSES OF WATER A DAY

Even being a little dehydrated makes you slower, weaker, and more likely to get injured. Drink water all day — not just at training. If your pee is dark yellow, you're behind. Aim for clear-to-light-yellow. Keep a bottle with you.

*"You can't out-train bad sleep,
bad food, and bad hydration. Ever."*

MORE IS ON THE WAY

THIS IS JUST THE *beginning.*

A full 12-week program. An off-ice training app. More drills. More games. More days like the five you just finished — built with the same method, designed specifically for hockey players.

COMING SOON

Follow along on Instagram

@ELITE_HOCKEY_DRILLS

*"Be the first to know when it drops. Weekly off-ice drills, coaching tips,
and behind-the-scenes content."*

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FROM THE COACH

COACH DAVID CIBOCH

M.ED. SPORT SCIENCE / STRENGTH &
CONDITIONING / HOCKEY

I'm a sport science coach who has spent the last decade working with hockey players — from first-time skaters all the way up to international competition. I also work full-time as a Physical Education and Sport Science teacher.

I built Elite Hockey Drills because the off-ice training world is full of generic, copy-paste programs that don't respect the sport or the player. Hockey is specific. Training should be specific too.

What you just did over these five days is real work — the same principles I use with the players I coach in person. If you take this seriously, you're already ahead of most kids your age. Keep going. Move well. Train smart. Have fun with it.

— *Coach David*

"The kids who train smart at 12 become the players everyone watches at 18."

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EXP 10+ YEARS COACHING

ROLES HOCKEY PERFORMANCE
COACH

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